

Day 15 - Subnetting (pt 3 VLSM)

Saturday, August 22, 2026 2:50 PM

15. SUBNETTING (VLSM) : PART 3

The process of subnetting Class A, Class B, and Class C is identical.

SUBNETTING CLASS A NETWORKS

Given a 10.0.0.0/8 network, you must create 2000 subnets which will be distributed to various enterprises. What prefix length must you use?

$2^{10} = 1024$ so $2^{11} = 2048$. We have to "borrow" 11 bits (Left to Right) to get enough subnets

0000 1010 . 0000 0000 . 000 | 00000 . 0000 0000

8 bits + 8 bits + 3 = 19 bits

0000 1010 . 0000 0000 . 000 | 00000 . 0000 0000 1111 1111 . 1111 1111 . 111 | 00000 . 0000 0000

255.255.224.0 is the Subnet mask

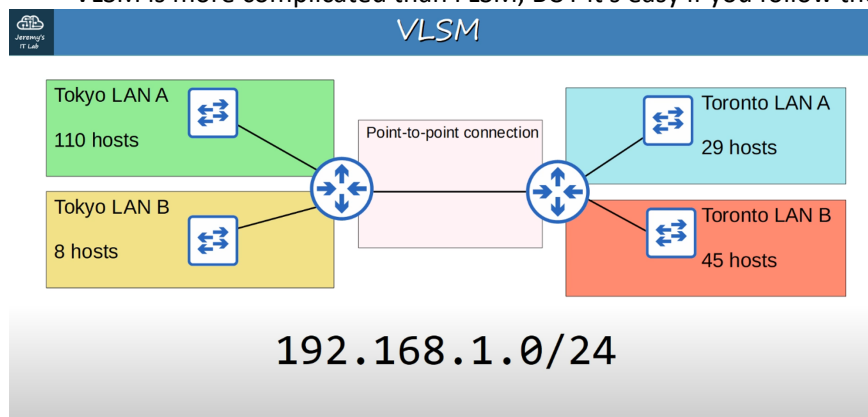
The answer is /19 (/8 + /11 = /19)

How many hosts per subnet? There are 13 host bits remaining so:

$2^{13} - 2 = 8190$ hosts per subnet

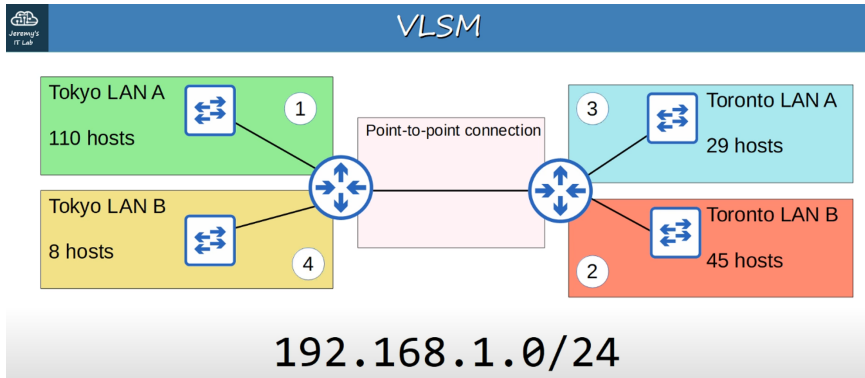
VARIABLE-LENGTH SUBNET MASKS (VLSM)

- Until now, we have practiced subnetting using FLSM (Fixed-Length Subnet Masks).
- This means that all of the subnets use the same prefix length (ie: Subnetting a Class C network into 4 subnets using /26)
- VLSM (Variable-Length Subnet Masks) is the process of creating subnets of different sizes, to make your use of network addresses more efficient.
- VLSM is more complicated than FLSM, BUT it's easy if you follow the steps correctly.



VLSM - Steps

- 1) Assign the largest subnet at the start of the address space.
- 2) Assign the second-largest subnet after it.
- 3) Repeat the process until all subnets have been assigned.



So, in order:

TOKYO LAN A (110 HOSTS)
TORONTO LAN B (45 HOSTS)
TORONTO LAN A (29 HOSTS)
TOKYO LAN B (8 HOSTS)
and
THE POINT TO POINT CONNECTION (between the two ROUTERS)
192.168.1.0 / 24

1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 | 0000 0000 (last is host octet = 254 usable hosts)

Shifting LEFT - we DOUBLE the # of hosts Shifting RIGHT - we HALF the # of hosts

TOKYO LAN A (we need to borrow 1 host bits, to the RIGHT, to leave enough for 2^7 or 128 hosts. More than enough for TOKYO A)

so:

192.168.1.0/25 (Network Address)
1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 . 0 | 000 0000
Converting remaining Host Bits to 1s:
0111 1111, we get 127 so
192.168.1.127/25 is the Broadcast Address

TOKYO LAN A

NETWORK ADDRESS: 192.168.1.0/25
BROADCAST ADDRESS: 192.168.1.127/25
FIRST USABLE: 192.168.1.1/25
LAST USABLE: 192.168.1.126/25
TOTAL NUMBER OF USABLE HOSTS: 126 ($2^7 - 2$)
Since TOKYO LAN A is 192.168.1.127, the next Subnet (TOKYO LAN B) starts at 192.168.1.128 (Network Address)

TORONTO LAN B

NETWORK ADDRESS: 192.168.1.128 / 26
BROADCAST ADDRESS: 192.168.1.191 / 26
FIRST USABLE: 192.168.1.129 / 26

LAST USABLE: 192.168.1.190 / 26

TOTAL NUMBER OF USABLE HOSTS: 62 ($2^6 - 2$)

We need to borrow to get enough for 45 hosts.

128	64	32	16	8	4	2	1
x	x	0	0	0	0	0	0

1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 . 10 | 00 0000

192 . 168 . 1 . 128

1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 . 10 | 11 1111

192 . 168 . 1 . 191 (Broadcast Address)

TORONTO LAN A

We need to borrow to get enough for 29 hosts.

128	64	32	16	8	4	2	1
x	x	x	0	0	0	0	0

1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 . 110 | 0 0000

192.168.1.192 (Net Address)

1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 . 110 | 1 1111

192.168.1.224 (Broadcast address)

NETWORK ADDRESS: 192.168.1.192 / 27

BROADCAST ADDRESS: 192.168.1.223 / 27

FIRST USABLE: 192.168.1.193 / 27

LAST USABLE: 192.168.1.222 / 27

TOTAL NUMBER OF USABLE HOSTS: 30 hosts ($2^5 - 2$)

TOKYO LAN B We need to borrow to get enough for 8 hosts. Remember total usable hosts is equal to $x - 2$.

128	64	32	16	8	4	2	1
x	x	x	x	0	0	0	0

1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 . 1110 | 0000

192.168.1.224 (Net Address)

1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 . 1110 | 1111

192.168.1.239 (Broadcast address)

NETWORK ADDRESS: 192.168.1.224 / 28

BROADCAST ADDRESS: 192.168.1.239 / 28

FIRST USABLE: 192.168.1.225 / 28

LAST USABLE: 192.168.1.238 / 28

TOTAL NUMBER OF USABLE HOSTS: 14 hosts ($2^4 - 2$)

POINT TO POINT CONNECTIONS

We need to borrow to get enough for 4 hosts. Remember total usable hosts is equal to $x - 2$.

128	64	32	16	8	4	2	1
x	x	x	x	x	x	0	0

1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 . 1111 00 | 00

192.168.1.240 (Net Address)

1000 0000 . 1010 1000 . 0000 0001 . 1111 00 | 11

192.168.1.243 (Broadcast address)

NETWORK ADDRESS: 192.168.1.240 / 30

BROADCAST ADDRESS: 192.168.1.243 / 30

FIRST USABLE: 192.168.1.241 / 30

LAST USABLE: 192.168.1.242 / 30